

Ξενοκράτης ὁ Χαλκηδόνιος

Xenocrates of Chalcedon and the Platonic School

eul_aid: hda

Period: [Κλασική](#) [Classical](#)
Dialect: [Φιλοσοφική Ἀττική](#) [Attic](#) [Philosophical](#)
Domain: [Φιλοσοφία](#) [Philosophy](#)
Format: [Πραγματεία](#) [Treatise](#)
Affiliation: [Platonist](#)

Xenocrates of Chalcedon was a Greek philosopher of the 4th century BCE, living from approximately 396 to 314 BCE. He moved to Athens as a young man and became a student of Plato. After Plato's death, he studied under Speusippus, and in 339 BCE he was elected the third head, or scholarch, of Plato's Academy, a position he held for 25 years.

Ancient sources describe him as a man of austere and unwavering moral character. He was a prolific writer, but none of his works survive complete. They are known only through titles and fragments quoted by later authors. His many lost treatises covered a wide range of topics, including *On the Good*, *On the Soul*, *On the Gods*, and *On Happiness*, aiming to systematize Platonic doctrine.

As a pivotal early Platonist, Xenocrates played a crucial role in shaping the school's teachings. According to modern scholars, his most lasting contribution was his formal division of philosophy into three parts: Physics, Ethics, and Logic, a framework that became standard in later philosophy. He also developed influential interpretations of Plato's ideas, identifying the Platonic Forms with mathematical numbers and proposing a system of intermediate divine beings, or daemons. His long leadership helped stabilize and define the Academy after Plato's death, influencing later Platonist and Stoic thought.

Works (1)

- [Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ τῶν Πλάτωνος Μαθητῶν](#) · [Fragments on Plato's Disciples](#) · 161 passages

Other Platonist Authors

- [Ἀλβίνος ὁ Πλατωνικός](#) · [Albinus the Platonist](#) · 2 works
- [Ἀλέξανδρος Λυκοπολίτης](#) · [Alexander of Lycopolis](#) · 1 work
- [Ἄνωνυμος ὑπόμνημα εἰς τὸν Πλάτωνος Θεαίτητον](#) · [Anonymous Commentary on Plato](#) · 1 work
- [Ἀρίμνηστος](#) · [Arimnestus the Philosopher](#) · 1 work
- [Ἀττικός](#) · [Atticus the Philosopher](#) · 1 work
- [Κάσσιος Λογγίνος](#) · [Cassius Longinus the Philosopher](#) · 3 works
- [Κέλσος ὁ Πλατωνικός](#) · [Celsus the Platonist](#) · 1 work
- [Κράντωρ ὁ Σολεύς](#) · [Crantor of Soli](#) · 2 works
- [Εὐδρόμος](#) · [Eudromus the Philosopher](#) · 1 work

- [Ἡρακλείδης ὁ Ποντικός · Heraclides of Pontus](#) · 2 works
- [Ἡρακλείδης ὁ Ποντικός · Heraclides of Pontus II](#) · 1 work
- [Ἡρακλείδης ὁ Ποντικός · Heraclides of Pontus III](#) · 1 work